

E-Learning Website Auditing and Digital Marketing Implementation

Case Study: Coursera

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1. Executive Summary

This capstone analyses Coursera as an e-learning platform and develops a practical website redesign and integrated digital marketing plan. The project covers website UX, on-page SEO, technical SEO, keyword research, content marketing, social media, paid advertising, analytics and conversion optimization. A separate demonstration website named LearnPro has been created to represent the proposed redesign. LearnPro is a student project and is not an official Coursera website.

2. Project Objectives

The objectives are to audit the selected e-learning website; identify UX, content and SEO improvement opportunities; propose a clearer course-discovery journey; develop a keyword and SEO strategy; create a content and social media plan; design a paid advertising proposal; define analytics and KPIs; and produce a working demonstration website.

3. About Coursera

Coursera is an online learning platform founded in 2012 by Andrew Ng and Daphne Koller. It provides courses, professional certificates, Specializations and degree programs through partnerships with universities and companies. Its public website covers areas including business, data science, computer science, information technology, AI, marketing and personal development.

4. Target Audience

The project focuses on college students, MBA students, working professionals, job seekers, career changers, lifelong learners and organizations seeking employee learning. The primary campaign segment is students and young professionals approximately 18–35 who want flexible, career-oriented online learning.

5. Website Audit

The strategic audit focuses on user experience, navigation, search and discovery, course information, calls-to-action, mobile usability, content structure and conversion flow. A major opportunity is to simplify the journey from a broad course catalogue to a goal-based learning path. Technical metrics such as Core Web Vitals, crawl errors and backlink counts should be validated with live tools before being presented as measured results.

6. Redesign Proposal

The proposed journey is: Homepage → Career Goal → Recommended Learning Path → Course → Benefits/Skills → Reviews → CTA → Enrollment. The homepage should use clearer goal-based entry points such as Start a New Career, Get Promoted, Learn AI and Learn Digital Marketing. Course pages should prominently show level, duration, provider, skills, certificate information, reviews and a primary CTA.

7. Competitor Analysis

For academic comparison, Coursera can be compared with Udemy and edX on university partnerships, industry partnerships, professional certificates, degree programs, self-paced learning, content breadth and career positioning. The proposed improvement is not simply adding more courses, but making the existing catalogue easier to navigate using goal-based discovery and personalization.

8. Keyword Research and SEO

Priority keyword themes include online courses, online learning, online courses with certificates, digital marketing course, data analytics course, AI courses online, professional certificate courses and career-focused long-tail queries. Keyword volume and competition should be verified in Google Keyword Planner or another SEO tool before final academic submission.

9. On-Page SEO

Recommendations include descriptive title tags and meta descriptions, one clear H1, logical H2 headings, optimized images and ALT text, descriptive URLs, internal linking between courses and learning guides, FAQ content where appropriate, and stronger landing-page copy aligned with search intent.

10. Technical SEO

The implementation checklist includes mobile optimization, image compression, script optimization, Core Web Vitals monitoring, XML sitemap, robots.txt, canonical URLs, structured data where applicable, and Google Search Console monitoring for indexing and search-performance issues.

11. Off-Page SEO

The strategy includes educational guest articles, digital PR, expert interviews, university and industry resources, original research reports and useful educational assets that can naturally attract relevant backlinks.

12. Content Marketing

Four content pillars are recommended: Career Growth, Digital Skills, Learning Advice and Industry Trends. Content formats include blogs, short videos, carousels, guides, infographics and learner stories. Each piece should connect an informational need with a relevant learning path or course category.

13. Social Media Strategy

Instagram should focus on short educational content, Reels, carousels and learning motivation. LinkedIn should focus on professional development, industry trends and career content. YouTube should provide longer educational videos and Shorts. Facebook can support community engagement, blog distribution and promotional content.

14. Paid Advertising

A proposed 30-day test budget is ■70,000: Google Search Ads ■30,000, Meta Ads ■20,000, YouTube Ads ■10,000 and remarketing ■10,000. These are student-proposed budget figures, not Coursera's actual advertising spend. Campaigns should be optimized using conversion tracking and cost-per-acquisition data.

15. Conversion Optimization

The recommended conversion journey is Course Discovery → Course Consideration → Enrollment. Course pages should make benefits, skills, level, duration, reviews, provider and certificate information easy to find. Clear primary CTAs and reduced information friction should support decision-making.

16. Analytics and Reporting

GA4 can measure users, sessions, engagement, landing pages, traffic sources and conversion events. Google Search Console can measure impressions, clicks, CTR, average position and queries. A KPI dashboard should connect traffic to course-page engagement and enrollment-related conversions.

17. Proposed KPIs

Suggested 90-day project targets are +20% organic traffic, +10% organic CTR, +15% course-page engagement, +20% social engagement, +15% qualified paid traffic and +10% landing-page conversion rate. These are proposed targets, not measured results.

18. 30/60/90 Day Implementation

Days 1–30: fix high-priority UX issues, optimize key pages, launch content and test ads. Days 31–60: review keyword and landing-page performance, expand content and test new creative. Days 61–90: scale successful campaigns, build useful backlinks, improve conversion rates and publish monthly performance reports.

19. Benefits

The project demonstrates practical application of MBA Digital Marketing concepts, produces a portfolio-ready website, provides a structured SEO and marketing strategy, and develops skills in website optimization, content planning, paid media and analytics.

20. Conclusion

The project recommends an integrated approach: Attract the right audience → Help users discover the right learning path → Build trust → Encourage enrollment → Measure results. The LearnPro demo website translates the proposed UX improvements into a working student project.

21. Website Features

- Responsive layout
- Goal-based career paths
- Course cards and CTAs
- Learning Hub/blog section
- Conversion-focused hero section
- Mobile-friendly navigation
- Interactive enrollment demo
- SEO-friendly page metadata

22. Project Deliverables

- Working LearnPro website
- Detailed Coursera case-study report
- SEO keyword and content spreadsheet
- 30-day content strategy
- Paid advertising budget proposal
- PowerPoint presentation
- Project feedback video script

- GitHub-ready README

23. References

Coursera official website: <https://www.coursera.org/>

Coursera About: <https://www.coursera.org/about>

Coursera Digital Marketing courses: <https://www.coursera.org/courses?query=digital%20marketing>

Google Search Central documentation: <https://developers.google.com/search>

Google Analytics: <https://analytics.google.com/>

Google Search Console: <https://search.google.com/search-console>

Udemy: <https://www.udemy.com/>

edX: <https://www.edx.org/>